

Patient Name: Kathryn Copeland

DOB: June 28, 1985

Date: March 13, 2025

Provider Name & Credentials: Kim Tran, M.D.

Facility: UT Southwestern Medical Center
600 S Main St 3rd Floor, Suite 500
Fort Worth, TX 76104

Dire Needs Letter

To Whom It May Concern,

I am the primary care physician for Kathryn Copeland. She has been under my care for multiple chronic medical conditions that significantly impair her daily functioning, including hypermobile Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome (hEDS), Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome (POTS), Mast Cell Activation Syndrome (MCAS), Long COVID/ME-CFS, Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome (MALS), Hashimoto's thyroid disease, immune system abnormalities (hypergammaglobulinemia), a vestibular schwannoma, and complications from toxic mold exposure.

These conditions collectively cause severe fatigue, post-exertional malaise, autonomic instability, chronic pain, tremors, migraines, visual disturbances, and cognitive dysfunction (slowed processing, memory impairment, and brain fog). Even minimal exertion can trigger symptom flares requiring extended rest.

Since early 2025, Ms. Copeland's health has worsened. She was displaced from her home in June/July 2025 due to toxic mold and has been forced to live in unstable hotel housing. This disruption prevents her from accessing prescribed home health services, therapy, and ongoing medical care, further compromising her health.

In my professional medical opinion, Ms. Copeland is unable to sustain an eight-hour workday, five days per week, on a regular and continuing basis. She requires frequent unscheduled breaks, must recline or lie down throughout the day, and would miss multiple days of work each month due to her conditions. These limitations are consistent with the updated Residual Functional Capacity Questionnaire I completed on September 10, 2025.

Without disability benefits, Ms. Copeland cannot maintain safe housing, afford adequate food, secure medications, or access consistent treatment. This lack of resources is directly worsening her condition and places her at risk of irreversible decline.

It is my medical opinion that Ms. Copeland remains unable to perform substantial gainful activity and is in urgent need of disability benefits to stabilize her health and living situation.

Sincerely,

Kim Tran, M.D
UT Southwestern Medical Center